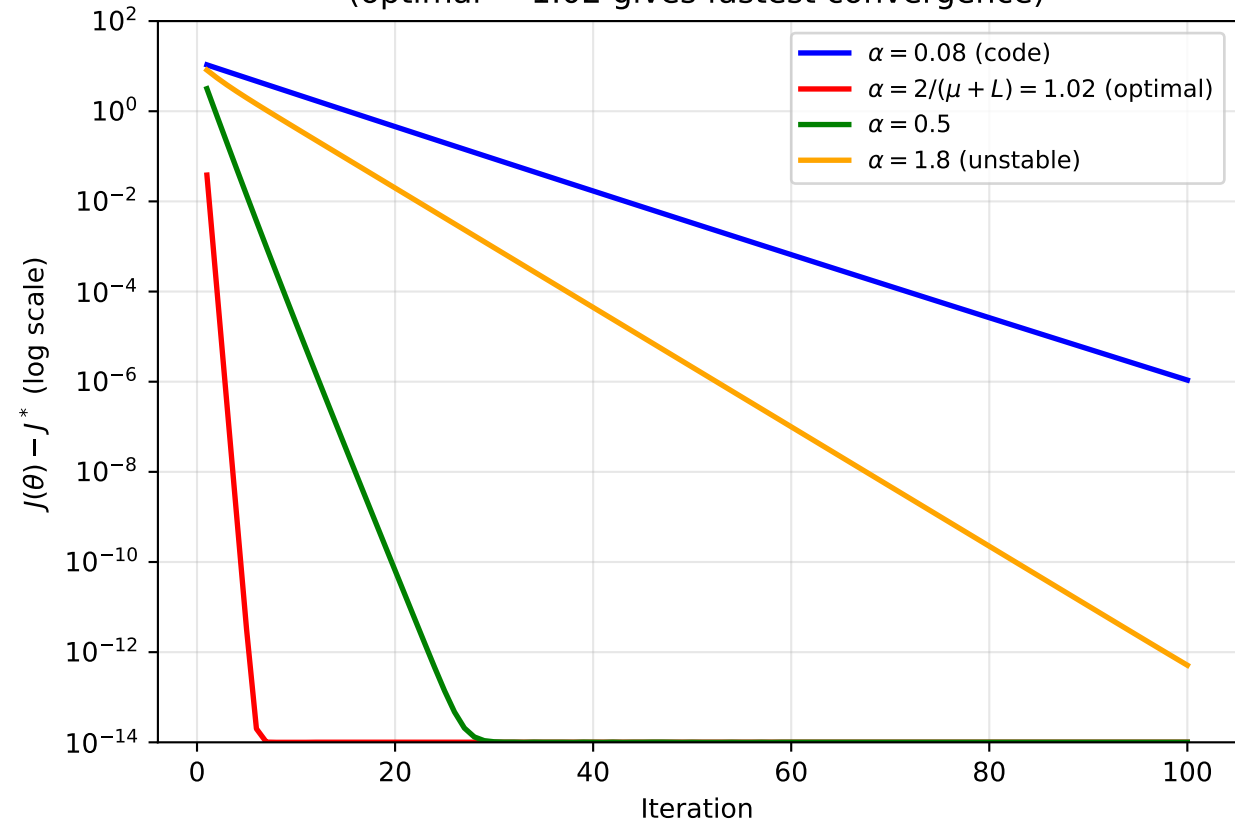


GD on Benchmark A: Step Size Effect
(optimal ≈ 1.02 gives fastest convergence)



GD Rate ρ vs α (Benchmark A, $\kappa \approx 1.12$)
(V-shape minimum at optimal step)

